

Keren Mertens Horn

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Current Appointments

University of Massachusetts Boston, College of Liberal Arts, Department of Economics
Associate Professor, 2019 to present; Assistant Professor, 2012 to 2019

Affiliations

Affiliated Faculty, UMass Boston Sustainable Solutions Lab, 2021 to present
Affiliated Faculty, UMass Boston Center for Social Policy, 2014 to present
Affiliated Faculty, NYU Furman Center for Real Estate and Urban Policy, 2012 to present

Education

PhD in Public Policy, New York University, 2012

Dissertation: Essays on Housing Policy, Schools and Neighborhood Change

Committee: Ingrid Gould Ellen (chair), Katherine O'Regan, and Amy Ellen Schwartz

MUP, New York University Robert F. Wagner Graduate School of Public Service, 2007

BA in Psychology, University of Pennsylvania, summa cum laude, 2003

Research

Selected Journal Articles

- “Impacts of Climate Hazards on Employment and Earnings by Hazard Type, Industry, Race and Ethnicity.” Co-authored with Dania Francis. *RSF: The Russell Sage Foundation Journal of the Social Sciences*, 2026, 12(4): 134–155. doi: 10.7758/RSF.2026.12.4.06
- “Restaurant Advertising Expenditure Trends in US Counties by Race, Ethnicity and Income.” Co-authored with Briana Joy K. Stephenson, Sarah N. Bleich, and Dania V. Francis. *Journal of Urban Health*, 2026, Jan. 6: 1–12. doi: 10.1007/s11524-025-01039-x
- “Stable School Integration.” Co-authored with Dania Francis. *Race and Social Problems*, 2023, 15: 215–228. doi: 10.1007/s12552-021-09349-w
- “Do Housing Vouchers Improve Academic Performance? Evidence from New York City.” Co-authored with Amy Schwartz, Ingrid Ellen, and Sarah Cordes. *Journal of Policy Analysis and Management*, 2020, 39(1): 131–158. doi: 10.1002/pam.22183
- “Has Falling Crime Invited Gentrification.” Co-authored with Ingrid Ellen and Davin Reed. *Journal of Housing Economics*, 2019, 46: 101636. doi: 10.1016/j.jhe.2019.101636

- “Points for Place: Can State Governments Shape Siting Patterns for Low-Income Housing Tax Credit Developments.” Co-authored with Ingrid Ellen. *Housing Policy Debate*, 2018, 28(5): 727–745. doi: 10.1080/10511482.2018.1443487
- “Gateway to Opportunity? Disparities in Neighborhood Conditions Among Low-Income Housing Tax Credit Residents.” Co-authored with Ingrid Ellen and Yiwen Kuai. *Housing Policy Debate*, 2018, 28(4): 572–591. doi: 10.1080/10511482.2017.1413584
- “Is Home Sharing Driving up Rents? Evidence from Airbnb in Boston.” Co-authored with Mark Merante. *Journal of Housing Economics*, 2017, 38: 14–24. doi: 10.1016/j.jhe.2017.08.002
- “Why Don’t Housing Choice Voucher Recipients Live Near Better Schools? Insights from Big Data.” Co-authored with Ingrid Ellen and Amy Schwartz. *Journal of Policy Analysis and Management*, 2016, 35(4): 884–905. doi: 10.1002/pam.21929
- “Poverty Concentration and the Low Income Housing Tax Credit: Effects of Siting and Tenant Composition.” Co-authored with Katherine O’Regan and Ingrid Ellen. *Journal of Housing Economics*, 2016, 34: 49–59. doi: 10.1016/j.jhe.2016.08.001

Selected Submitted and Working Papers

- “Remote Work and the Decline in the Big-City Child Penalty.” with Ilaria D’Angelis. August 2026. Under review.
- “Understanding the Congestion Child Penalty: Can Remote Work Attenuate It.” with Ilaria D’Angelis. January 2026. Revise and resubmit, *Labour Economics*. Presented at NBER Summer Institute, Gender in the Economy, 2026.
- “Recovering from Displacement: Gender, Family, and Labor Supply within Households.” with Luwen Mai. May 2026. Under review.
- “Displacement During the Great Recession: Local Labor Markets, Outside Options, and Worker Adjustments.” with Henry Pollakowski, Jeffrey Zabel, and Joseph Chance. April 2026. Revise and resubmit, *Journal of Regional Science*.

Selected Book Chapters and Reports

- “Schools and Neighborhoods.” with Amy Schwartz. Forthcoming 2026.
- “Are We in a Bubble? Understanding House Price Trends in Massachusetts During COVID-19.” Co-authored with Charlotte Burlingame. *MassBenchmarks*, 2022, 24(1): 24–32.
- “What the Next Mayor of Boston Needs to Do about the Affordable Housing Crisis in Boston.” Co-authored with Meghan Kallman. Report sponsored by the Boston Area Research Initiative, 2021.
- “Housing and Educational Opportunity: Characteristics of Local Schools Near Families with Federal Housing Assistance.” Co-authored with Ingrid Ellen. Report by the Poverty and Race Research Action Council, 2018.

Selected Grants

- Dean’s Research Grant, Congestion and Child Penalties. Co-Principal Investigator with Ilaria D’Angelis, \$5,000, September 2024–August 2026
- Russell Sage Foundation, Hurricanes, Floods and Fires: Understanding the Disparate Employment Impacts of Climate Hazards. Co-Principal Investigator with Dania Francis, RSF2305-43425, \$75,000, June 2024–May 2026
- National Institutes of Health/U54 UMass Boston–Dana Farber Harvard Cancer Partnership, Impact of Changing Restaurant Advertising on Weight Gain and Disparities. Co-Principal Investigator with Dania Francis and Sarah Bleich, \$150,000, September 2021–August 2023
- Smith Richardson Foundation, Major Economic Shocks: Variation in Future Employment and Earnings for Low- and Middle-Skill Displaced Workers. Co-Principal Investigator with Henry Pollakowski and Jeffrey Zabel, SRF2020-2355, \$200,000, January 2021–December 2023
- Russell Sage Foundation, The Geography of Worker Adaptation: Industry, Skills, Mobility, and Housing Costs. Co-Principal Investigator with Henry Pollakowski and Jeffrey Zabel, RSF1811-10303, \$149,997, June 2019–May 2021
- MacArthur Foundation, Do Housing Vouchers Improve Educational Outcomes for Low-Income Children? Co-Principal Investigator with Ingrid Ellen and Amy Schwartz, \$202,000, January 2013–December 2014
- Open Society Institute, Siting and Segregation: Exploring the Low Income Housing Tax Credit Program. Co-Principal Investigator with Ingrid Ellen, \$100,000, September 2014–August 2015

Selected Lectures and Presentations

- Urban Economics Association, 2025, 2023, 2016, 2014, 2010.
- Russell Sage Foundation, Climate Meeting, 2024. “Impacts of Climate Hazards on Employment and Earnings.”
- Federal Reserve Bank of Boston, New England Study Group, 2022. “The Geography of Worker Adaptation to Unanticipated Job Losses.”
- Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management, 2022, 2019, 2016, 2015, 2012, 2011, 2010, 2009.
- Conference on Poverty and Inequality, Harvard John F. Kennedy School of Government, 2018.
- MIT Department of Urban Studies and Planning, 2017. “Housing, Schools and Opportunity.”
- Lincoln Institute of Land Policy, Public Finance and Urban Economics Seminar, 2016.

Selected Media and Public Scholarship

- *The Atlantic*, “Commuting Is Bad: Particularly for Women.” by Stephanie H. Murray, December 16, 2025
- *Boston Globe*, “Want to Understand Why the Massachusetts Housing Market Is Broken? Look at This Chart.” by Andrew Brinker, June 16, 2025

- *Boston Globe*, “We Are at a Crisis Level on the Supply of Rental Housing.” by Kelly Garrity, June 19, 2022
- *Bloomberg*, “There’s New Research Behind the Contention that Airbnb Raises Rents.” by Alastair Boone, August 2, 2017
- *New York Times*, “How to Predict Gentrification: Look for Falling Crime.” by Emily Badger, January 5, 2017
- *Nitty Gritty City*, Substack, 2026–present. <https://kerenmertenshorn.substack.com/>

Teaching

- Data Visualization (Econ 305)
- Advanced Topics in Urban Economics (Econ 413)
- Urban Economic Environment (Econ 613)
- The Economics of Inequality (Econ 396)
- Economics of the Metropolitan Area (Econ 212G)
- Introduction to Microeconomics (Econ 101)

Honors and Fellowships

- University Conference on Teaching, Learning and Technology Innovation in Teaching Award, University of Massachusetts Boston, 2018
- Homer Hoyt Post-Doctoral Honoree, Homer Hoyt Institute, 2017–2018
- Lincoln Institute Scholar, Lincoln Institute of Land Policy, 2015
- Doctoral Dissertation Research Grant, Department of Housing and Urban Development, 2010–2011
- Furman Center for Real Estate and Urban Policy, Doctoral Fellowship, 2007–2010

Additional Information

- Board Member, MassBenchmarks, 2021–present
- U.S. Census Bureau, Special Sworn Status Researcher, 2008–present
- Bilingual Hebrew/English; fluent Spanish